

— MARKET CONDITIONS

**Billings are soft.
Should you still
spend on AI?**



SWIPE ►

— WHERE WE ARE

The ABI has been under 50 for years

July 2026 came in at 46.6, and the decline in architecture billings now runs close to three and a half years. This is not a blip anyone is waiting out.



— WHAT USUALLY HAPPENS

Tool budgets get cut first

In a soft market, software spending is the easiest line to defend cutting and the hardest to restart, because nobody wants to argue for it twice.



— WHAT WE ADVISE

Fund what shortens the pursuit

If work is scarce, the workflows worth funding are the ones touching how fast you respond and how well you scope. Everything else can wait for a better quarter.



— A E C E N T R I C

Spend narrow, not brave

A soft market is the wrong time for a firm wide rollout and the right time for one workflow with a number attached.

Full breakdown at the link in bio.

